

Alejandro Velazquez

Stevenage, United Kingdom | British citizen | aleuxuk@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/velazquezelejandro

SUMMARY

Product design leader with 20+ years building and scaling fintech, open banking, payments, SaaS and platform products across Europe and Latin America. Founding designer at Yapily, where I built the design function and now lead a team of two, owning product design across the platform.

Experienced partnering with executive leadership, product and engineering teams to deliver customer-centred solutions in highly regulated environments. Specialised in API-first platforms, developer experience, payment infrastructure and enterprise SaaS.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer & Design Manager — Founding Designer

Jan 2020 – Present

Yapily — London — one of Europe's leading Open Banking infrastructure providers, supporting millions of transactions annually

- Joined as the company's first designer and built the design function. Now manage a team of two product designers, owning hiring, onboarding and performance reviews; seven designers managed across six years as the team changed shape.
- Led the strategy, design and launch of Hosted Pages, the white-label bank-connection and consent flow spanning 1,500+ banks across 10+ countries, reducing customer integration effort from six months to two weeks. Now used by 200 companies, including Google, Adyen, Intuit, Ant Financial and Revolut.
- End-to-end conversion on Hosted Pages rose from around 20% at the 2023 beta to 65–75% today, varying by use case and market — achieved incrementally over three years by UX, frontend and backend working together, with design as one of the three contributing disciplines.
- Built the research practice with no dedicated research function: over 200 customer interviews at a sustained monthly cadence since 2020, a 2023–2026 programme of roughly 1,000 end-user usability sessions, commissioned usability and accessibility studies through Testbirds and Applause, and guerrilla testing for early iterations. Set up a bi-weekly feedback forum and shared prioritisation board with product, customer success, support and engineering.
- Defined the experimentation pipeline with product and built it in-house with engineering, enabling live A/B testing in production. Screen-level results include an 8% conversion improvement on bank selection, and reduced drop-off and user error on the QR code handoff.
- Led accessibility work to WCAG AA, documenting findings for the frontend team; the product now meets AA. Restructured the documentation information architecture through card sorting, testing findability and task flows before and after the change.
- Mapped the end-to-end customer journey across sales, customer success, technical services, support and operations, and led the information architecture for the Console redesign that followed. Ran a hackathon in which the team role-played as an outside consultancy, using only what a real customer can access, to surface the onboarding blockers. The Console is in beta; the Hosted Pages configurator has shipped in full, giving customers self-serve control over every screen in the flow.
- Wrote Yapily's open banking UX guidance for customers building their own experiences — covering end-to-end flows, consent screens, consent dashboards, return experiences, re-consent journeys and checkouts — delivered as documentation plus interactive demos.
- Set the vision and problem framing for demo.yapily.com, led its design and maintain it with my team — an indexed library of live demo journeys running real end-to-end flows against mock and live banks, used in implementation, sales and RFI conversations.
- Built three design systems from scratch for different consumers — internal tools, the white-label customer-facing foundation, and the marketing site — documented in Storybook and Figma on a shared token layer. Built the contribution and approval governance jointly with the frontend lead, and handed each established system to a designer on the team.
- Led design across six rebrands and the yapily.com homepage redesign with marketing and two external agencies, and lead the team producing brand and sales collateral behind go-to-market.
- Partnered with executive leadership on product strategy, prioritisation and platform vision, and supported the compliance team on FCA presentations by working design decisions through compliance rather than submitting them for approval afterwards.
- Worked with designers and product managers at Google over two years as they built open banking products on Yapily. Currently leading migration of the design systems into AI tooling as part of a company-wide AI transformation.

Lead Product Designer

2018 – 2019

HeadBox — London — enterprise event technology and SaaS platform

- Led product design through a leadership transition with no reliable way to measure product performance. Fifteen customer interviews refocused the team on the enquiry-to-booking funnel, where only 20% of enquiries received a host proposal.
- Designed and launched the company's first SaaS product for venue partners, generating £150,288 ARR from 117 customers within three months — four times the prior model's performance — creating a new revenue stream beyond marketplace transactions.
- Established the design system, governance framework and research practice used across the organisation.
- Shipped the Enquiry Hub as a deliberately small experiment — London only, capped at £10k — which showed the platform connected hosts and guests well but converted poorly, and led to the pivot from marketplace to SaaS lead generation.

Lead Product Designer (Contract)

2017 – 2018

Caremoni / My Support Broker — London — personal health budget payments, with the NHS

- Designed a payment and reconciliation platform for a social enterprise managing NHS personal health budgets, replacing an entirely manual and error-prone process.
- Interviewed every party in the chain — operators, independent carers, care agencies and people receiving care — then ran a concierge pilot with a plain front end and payments still processed by hand, which corrected a wrong assumption about digital confidence and reframed the problem as admin burden.
- Shipped an operator dashboard for budget allocation, spend monitoring and NHS reporting, plus an app for carers and customers to request and authorise payments. A pilot cut paperwork and follow-up calls and largely automated NHS reporting.

Senior Product Designer (Contract)

Nov 2016 – Dec 2018

Docomo Digital — London — global payments and commerce infrastructure provider

- Led design initiatives for NOMO, a marketplace payments platform supporting merchant onboarding, compliance, wallet management and automated vendor payouts through APIs.
- Designed payment, payout and reconciliation experiences for international marketplaces and sharing-economy platforms, simplifying workflows involving settlements, merchant management and international payments.
- Collaborated with product, service design and engineering teams across Europe and Asia.

Lead Product Designer

Oct 2013 – 2016

Payfriendz — London — digital wallet and peer-to-peer payments platform

- Directed mobile and web experience design across multiple product releases with two designers and fifteen engineers, working closely with founders to define product strategy and platform evolution. Built the UI component system and mentored support staff into research roles.
- Designed user journeys supporting digital wallets, peer-to-peer payments and emerging embedded finance capabilities, and introduced user research and usability testing practices that informed prioritisation.
- Contributed to the platform's evolution from a consumer payments product towards a scalable fintech infrastructure offering.
- Result: £5M+ transferred by 150,000+ users; ranked #1–3 in the Apple App Store finance category.

Product Designer (Contract)

Jan 2013 – Oct 2013

Payago — Berlin — worked remotely from Philadelphia, USA

- Designed user experiences for prepaid card, digital banking and payment products, improving customer journeys and product adoption.

Design Analyst

Sep 2008 – Aug 2011

Globant — Argentina

- Designed enterprise products and digital experiences for organisations including Google, JP Morgan, PwC, Coca-Cola, Telefónica and Travelocity, working within multidisciplinary product and engineering teams.

Early Career

2005 – 2008

Andimol, Bilitee, Sysnet Mexico, Datasygma & Independent — Argentina

- Interaction design and UX/UI consultancy for Latin American firms (Andimol); founded Bilitee, a social network for developers and designers; motion design for Nokia HQ information screens (Sysnet, Mexico — worked remotely from Argentina); freelance and web design roles (Datasygma, independent).

EDUCATION

Escuela Da Vinci — Multimedia & Web Design

Universidad de Buenos Aires — Human Resources (Relaciones Laborales)

SKILLS

Design Leadership · Product Strategy · Product Discovery · Open Banking · Payments · Platform & API-first Products · Developer Experience · Enterprise SaaS · Design Systems · Design Operations · User Research · Experimentation & A/B Testing · Accessibility (WCAG AA) · Stakeholder Management · HTML, CSS & JavaScript